

ward SMSes but also for everyday work such as e-mail. The injuries inflicted on the fingers due to excessive cell phone use can be considered the equivalent of the Carpal Tunnel Syndrome (CTS) that results from incorrect position of the keyboard and mouse.

Recently, some owners of Blackberry phones were afflicted by the 'Blackberry Thumb' syndrome - courtesy prolonged and extensive use of their phone keypad. This debilitating malady is characterised by a throbbing sensation in the thumb. In some cases, people have also developed blisters due to thumb typing.

The human thumb, as you're aware, is the least dextrous of the digits. To make it undergo strenuous work by pressing buttons on a keypad a thousand times a day is unfair! Jokes apart, cell phone users must keep this in mind to prevent inconvenience and potential visits to the doctor.

For starters, avoid repetitive use of one finger. Instead of relying solely on your thumb, try using your index finger too; or, you could alternate between the thumbs of your hands. While there are some keypads that are ergonomically designed, the warning here is "Avoid Overuse."

7.5 The Camera Phone Controversy

The Delhi Public School MMS scandal shocked the nation. It also led to the arrest of auction site Bazee.com's CEO Avnish Bajaj. And thanks to the camera phone, there's been a series of intimate exposes of film celebrities. And it's not the paparazzi alone who capture video and images on their camera, but other regular users of mobile phones. For instance, last year, tabloids published intimate pictures of actress Kareena Kapoor with beau Shahid Kapoor, claimed to be shot by a fan at a Mumbai pub. More recently, actress Mallika Sherawat was caught up in a controversy involving an explicit MMS clip.

The Information Technology Act 2000 bans dissemination of